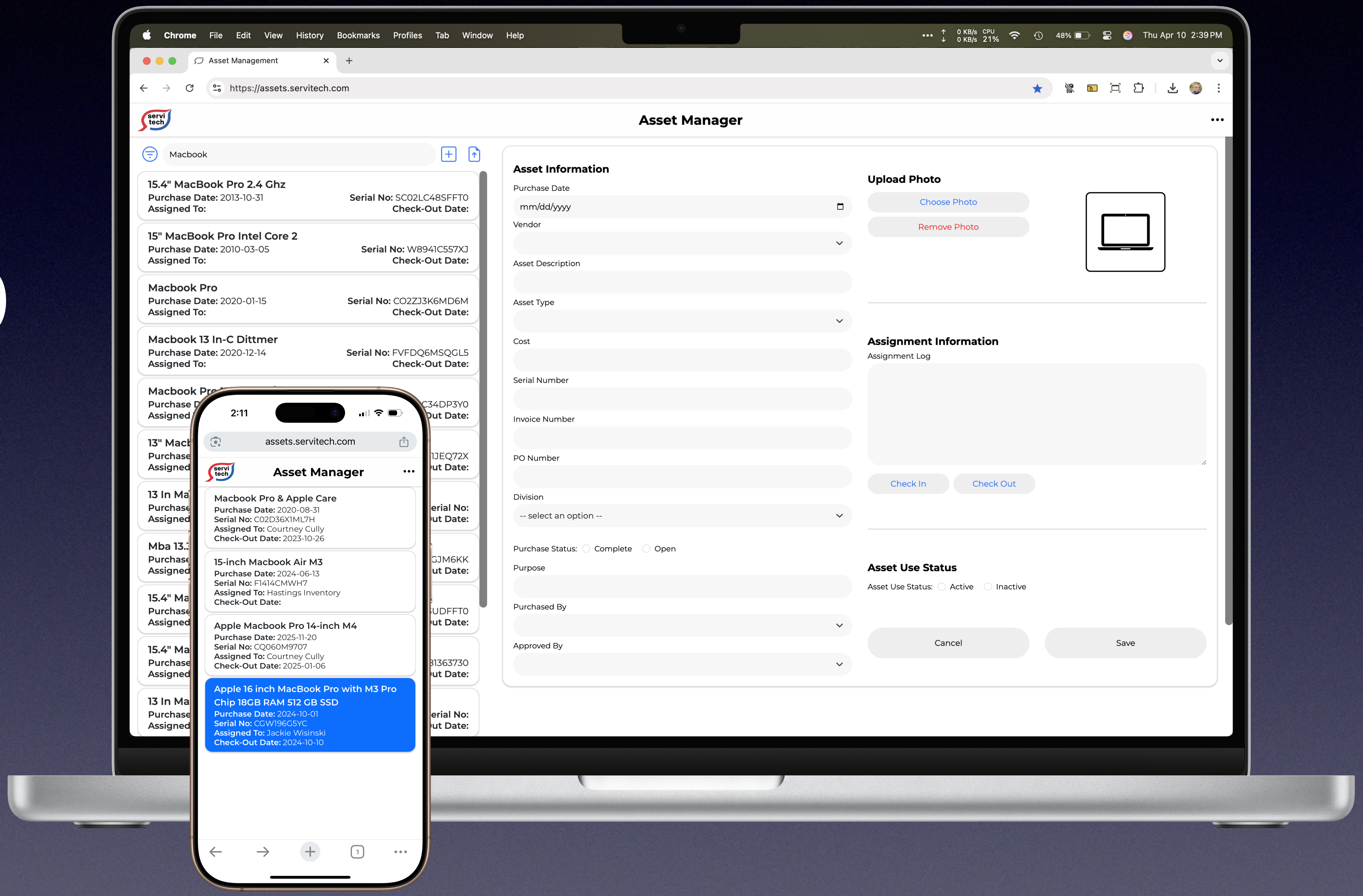
ServiTech, Inc.
Asset Manager Web App

Dan Morgan
Software Designer



Software Designer — ServiTech, Inc.
Project Duration: April–November 2023

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Project Overview

Project Description :

The Asset Manager is web app to manage a custom database of company assets.

Assets are tracked from purchase through retirement as to what employee or office they're assigned to and the condition at checkout and check-in.

Purpose:

The purchase approval and tracking of computers, tablets, and other capital purchases assigned to employees for their use was not done in a centrally managed way.

This project was conceived as a way to track a purchase from the purchase approval, through check-out assignment, check-in, and retirement or disposal.

Role & Responsibilities:

Software Designer for ServiTech, Inc.

- Mapped the event triggers
- Wire framed the low fidelity mockups in Adobe XD
- Designed the high fidelity prototypes in HTML/CSS using Bootstrap framework and some custom CSS classes
- Defined the database schema
- Populated the database with employee information

Contraints:

Project duration: April–November 2023

Cross-platform web app required to take into account devices from mobile phone, tablet, laptop, and desktop computers.

Light weight enough to run on rural internet and cell phone service.

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Users and Challenges

Primary Users :

- Division leaders
- Executive management team
- Technical support manager
- Purchasing agents

Challenges:

- 40 years of asset record accumulation without records of retirement or disposal
- Legacy databases and systems used to track assets for depreciation purposes, not for assignment or check-in
- Inconsistent use of metadata (Apple Computer vs MacBook vs Apple Computer; Apple tablet vs iPad)

Goals:

- Consistent interface and intuitive user experience
- RTU: Ready to use system with all current assets pre-loaded
- Track assets by location (3 physical offices, over 80 remote workers) and temporally (date checked out and checked in), and condition
- Cross-platfrom, mobile-first web app light weight enough to run on rural internet connections and cell service

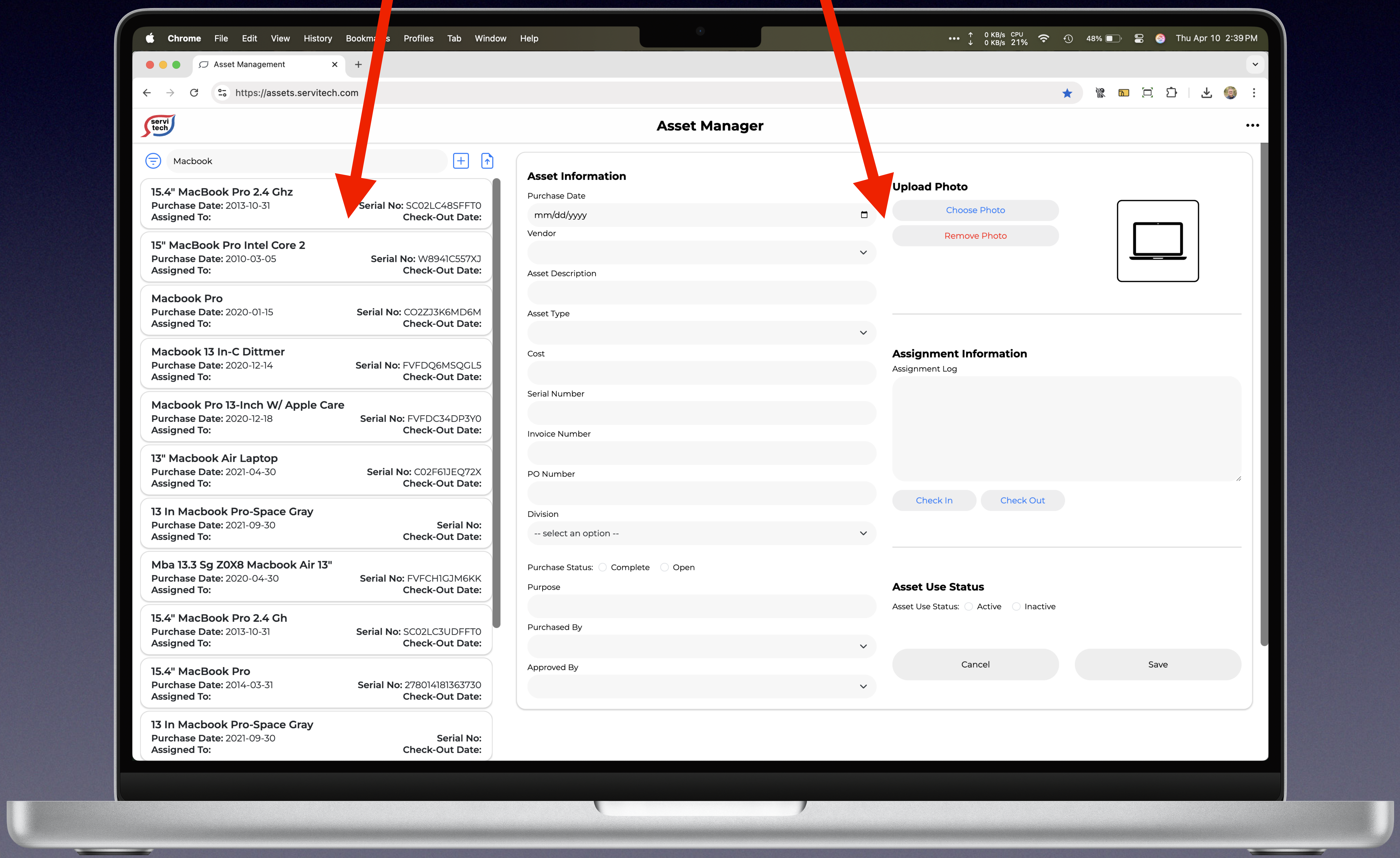
Process and Approach

Left one-third of viewport that scrolls

Right two-thirds of viewport that can scroll as needed

I mocked up rough layouts in Adobe XD to get a feel for how a ⅓–⅔ split of the viewport would look on laptops, desktops, tablets, while considering where the breakpoints would best be for a portrait oriented mobile phone device.

Early on I settled on a scrolling left pane with a list of the the devices in small cards with the details of each managed device in the larger right pane.



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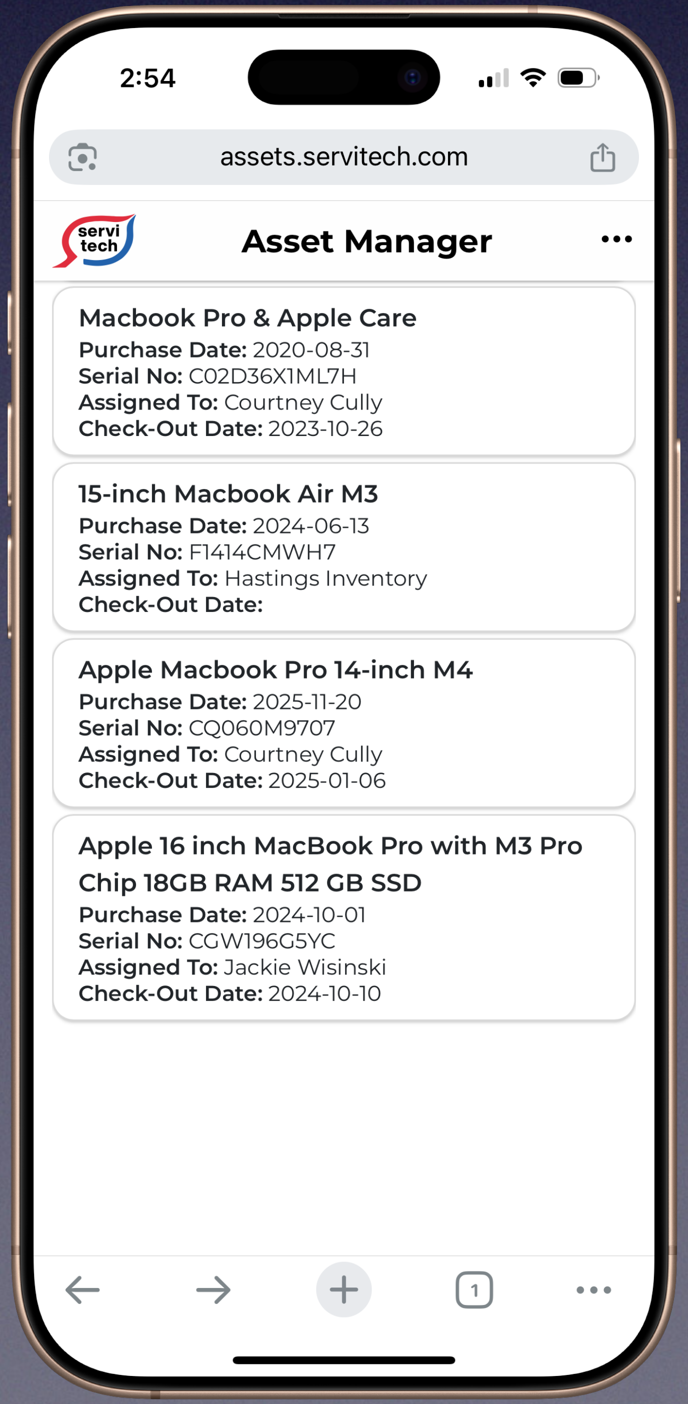
Process and Approach

The mobile phone view opens with a scrolling list of the devices in individual cards.

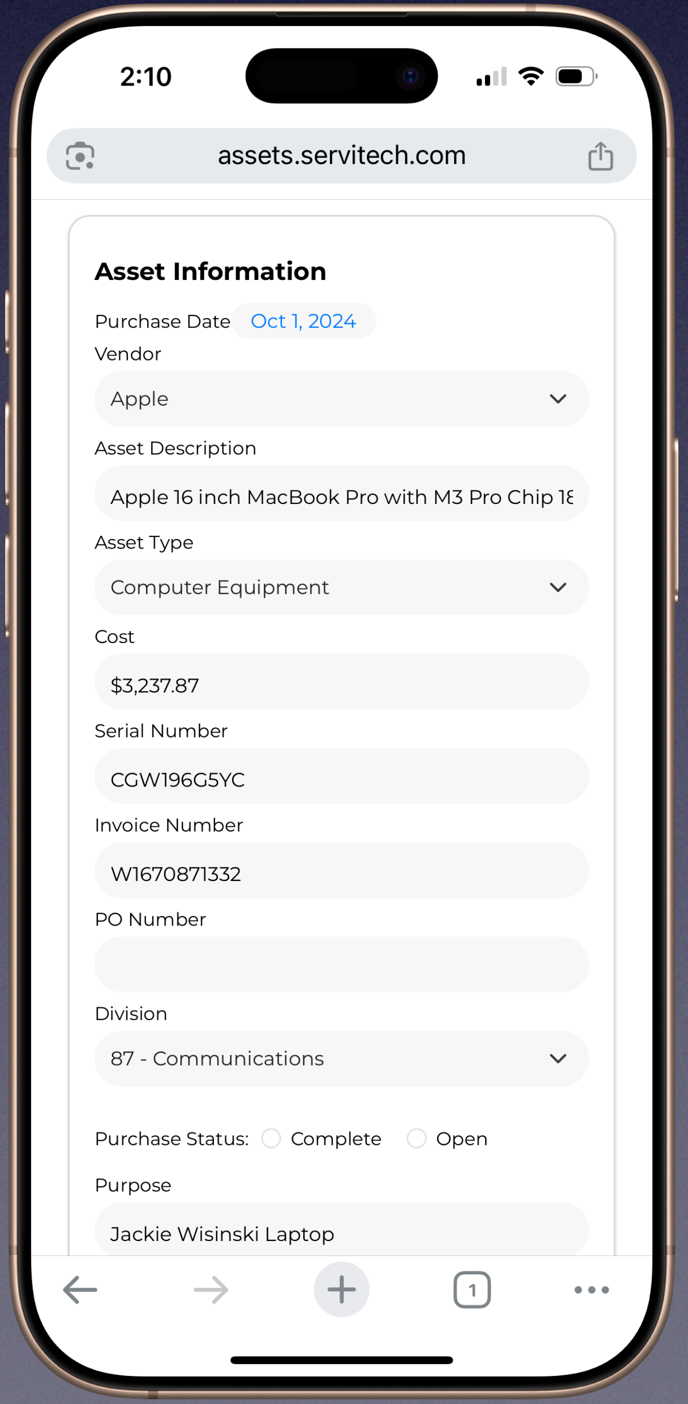
The detail view slides over when a card is selected.

For this project I provided working HTML and CSS files primarily using the Bootstrap framework and some custom CSS styling.

Scrolling list of devices on cards



Detail of a single device that scrolls vertically.



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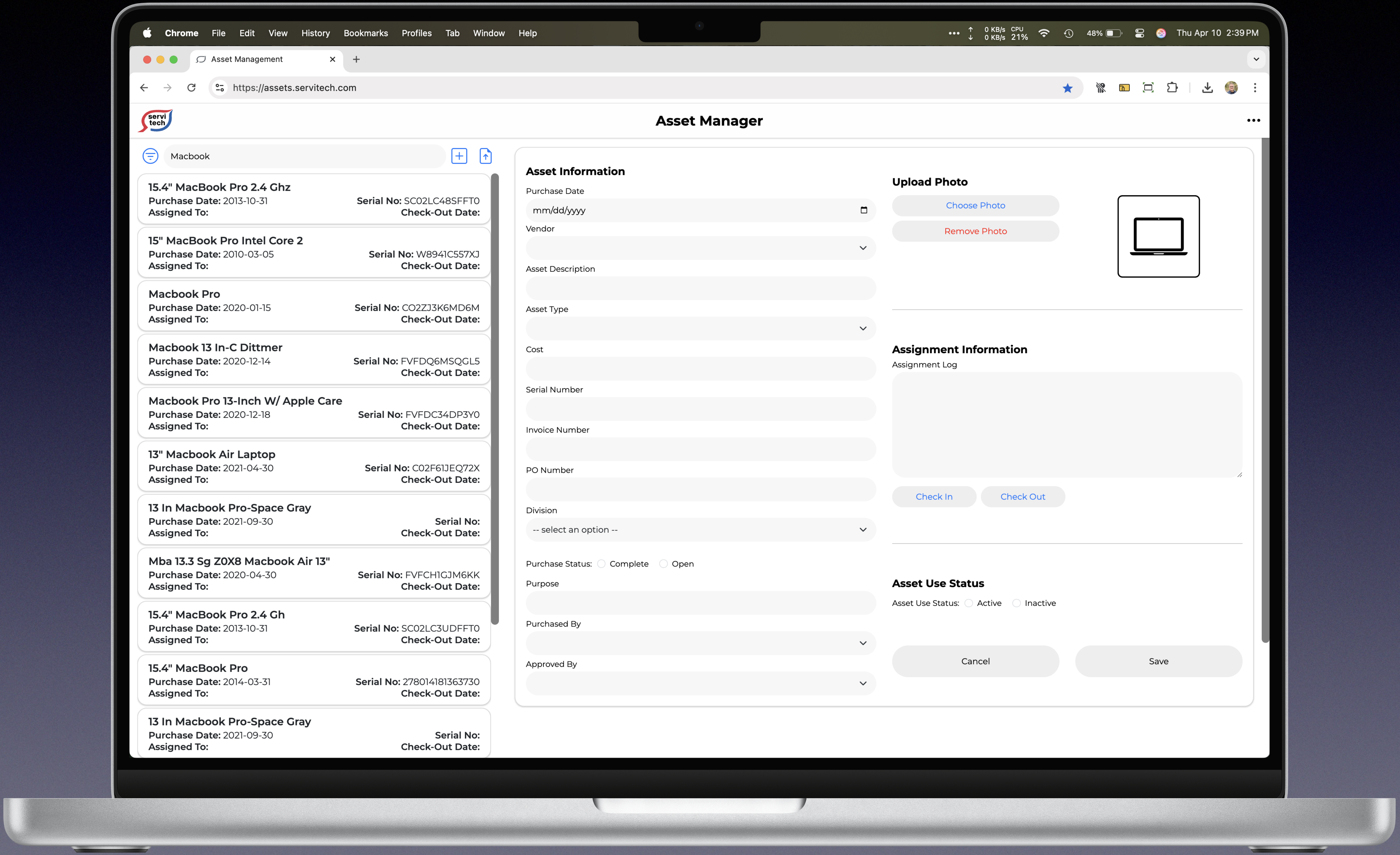
Final Designs



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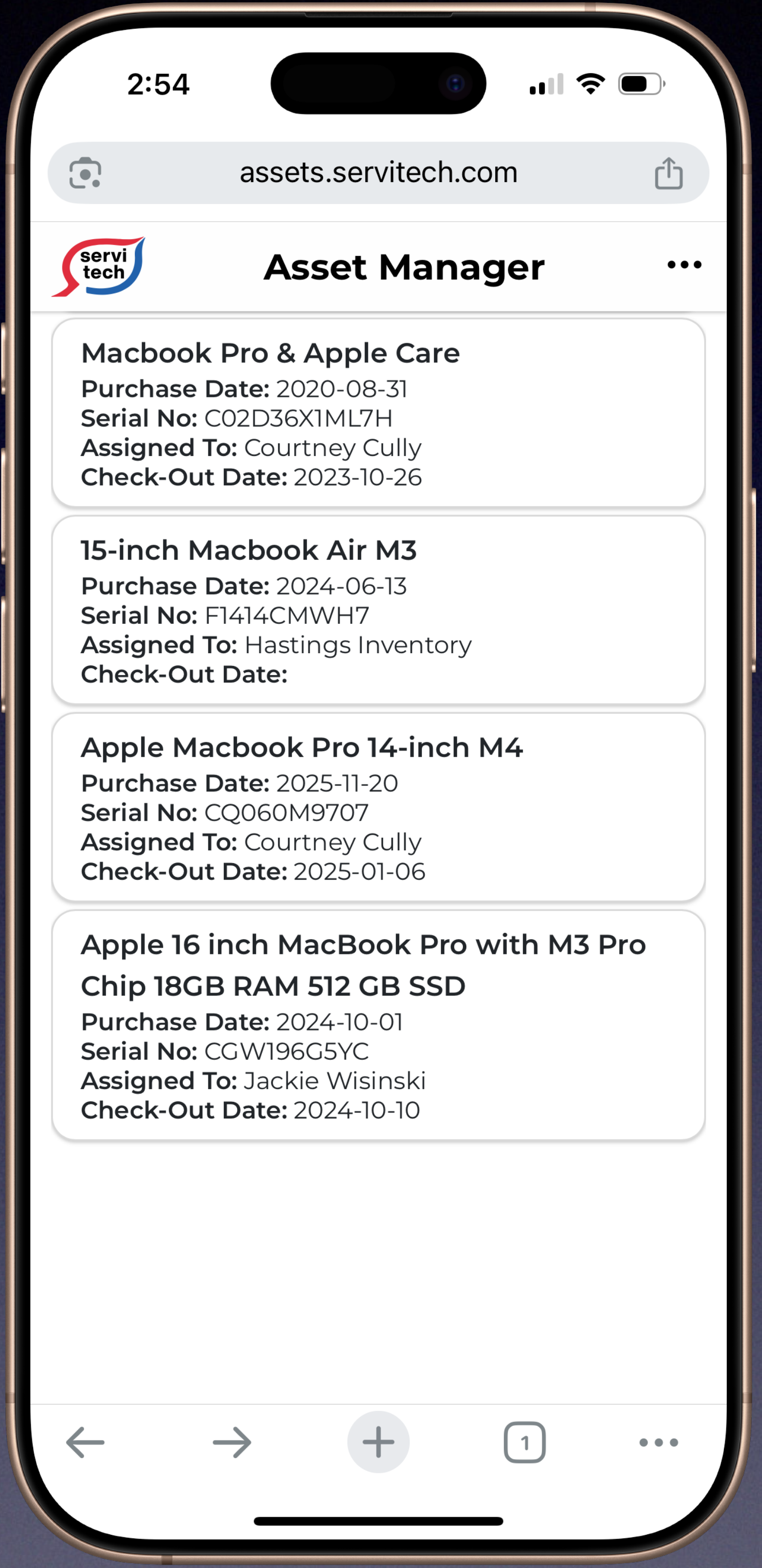
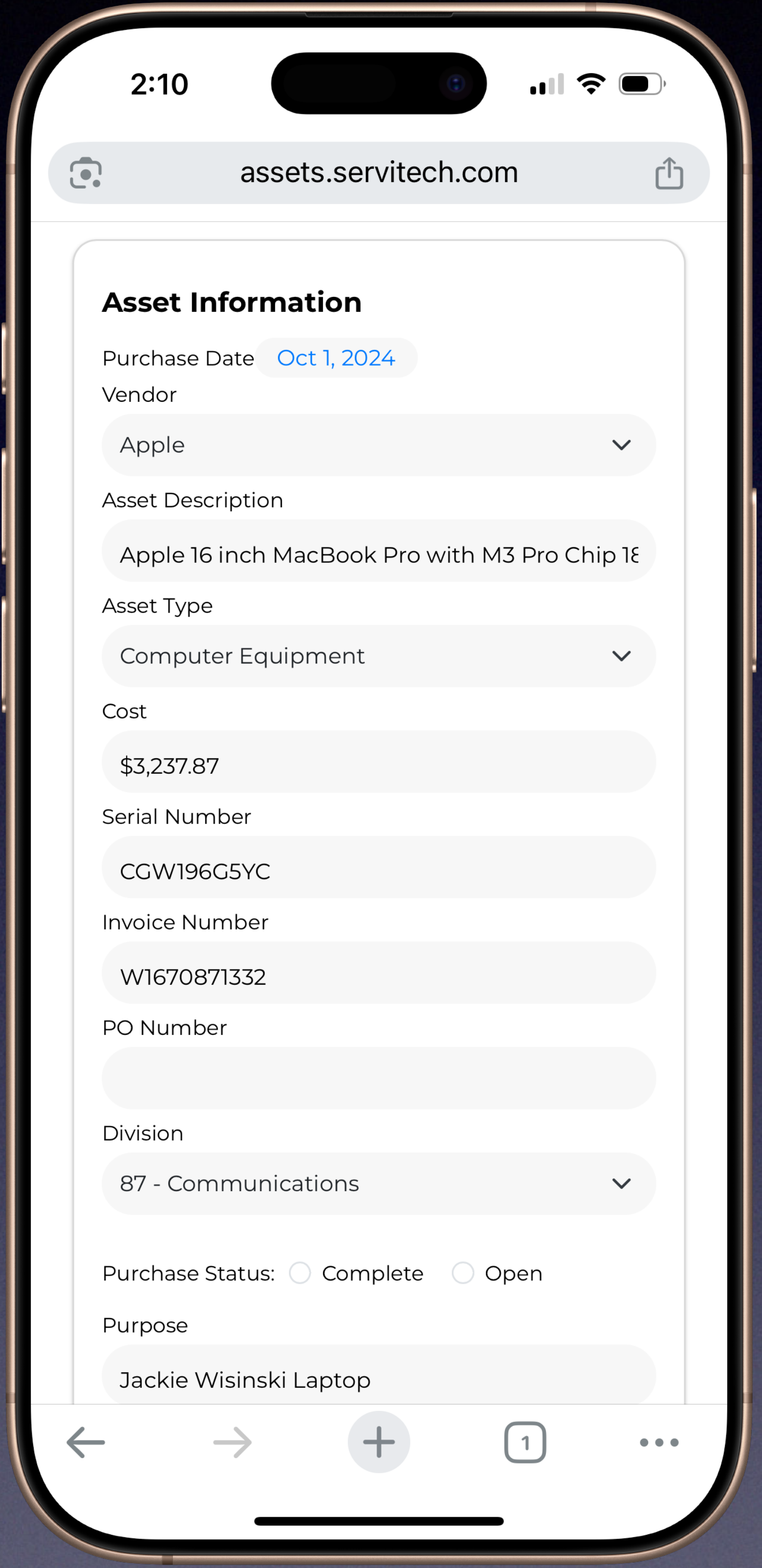
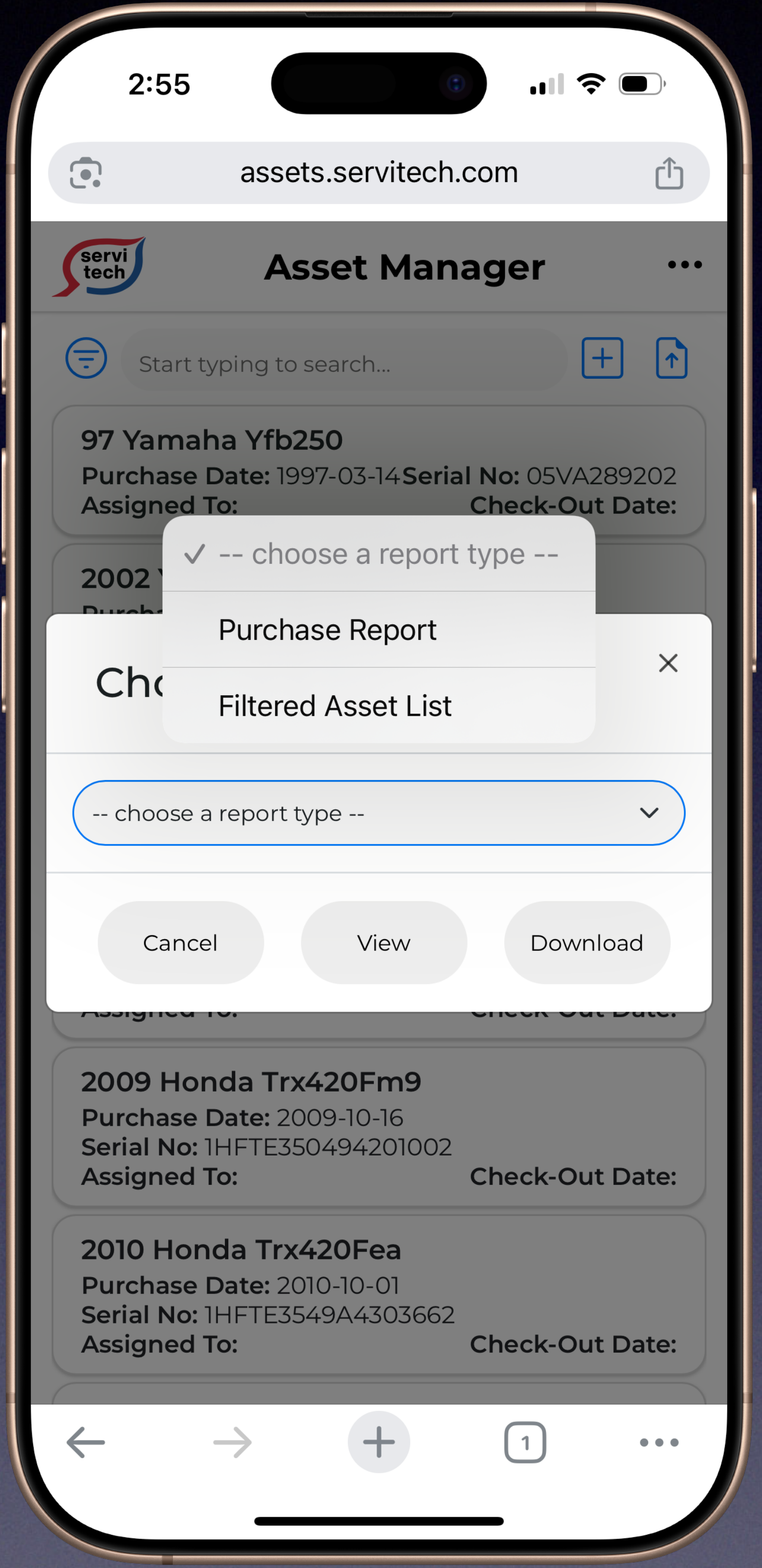
Final Designs



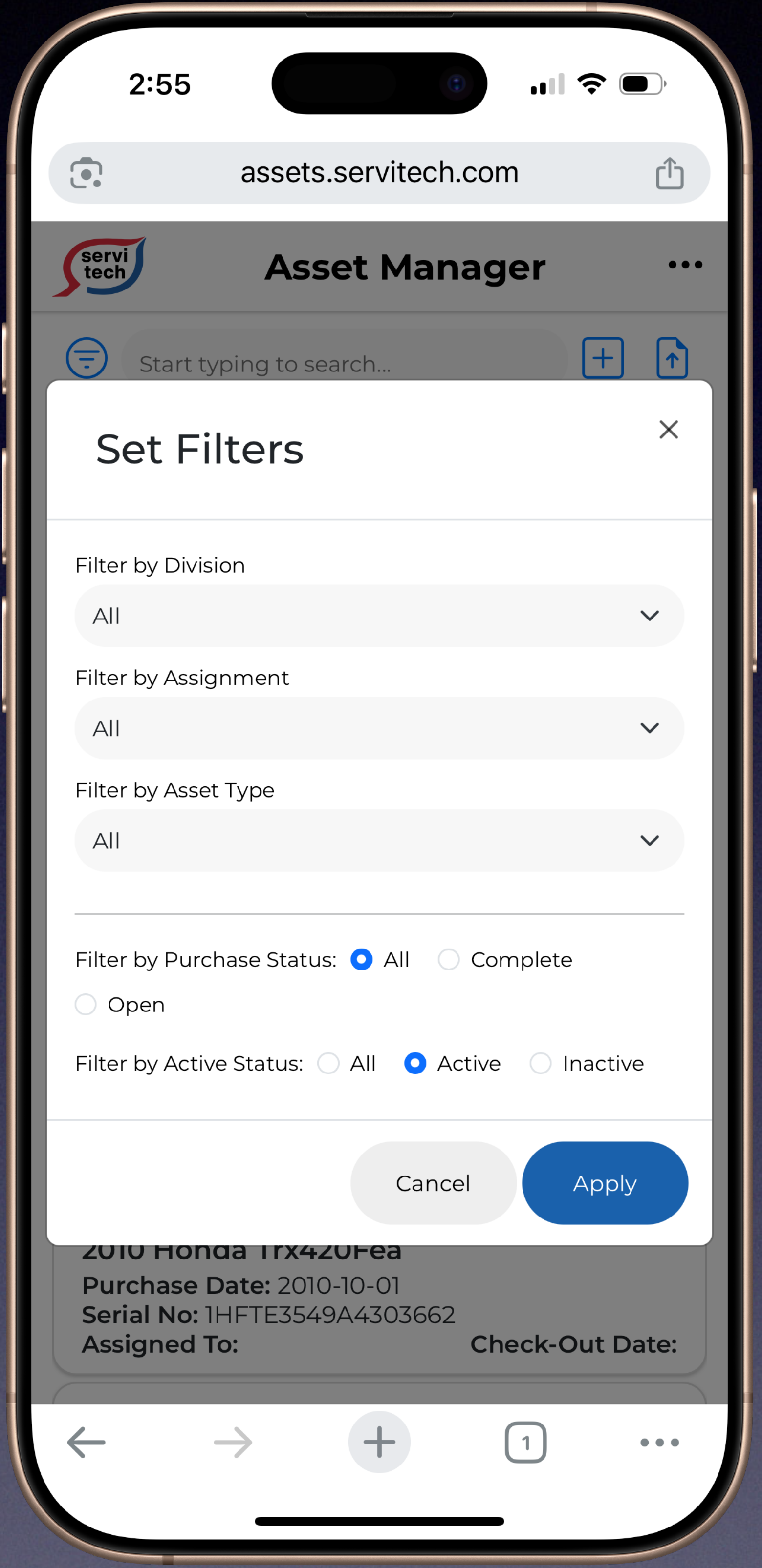
Scrolling List of Cards



Details Pane



Standard Reports



Filter Modal

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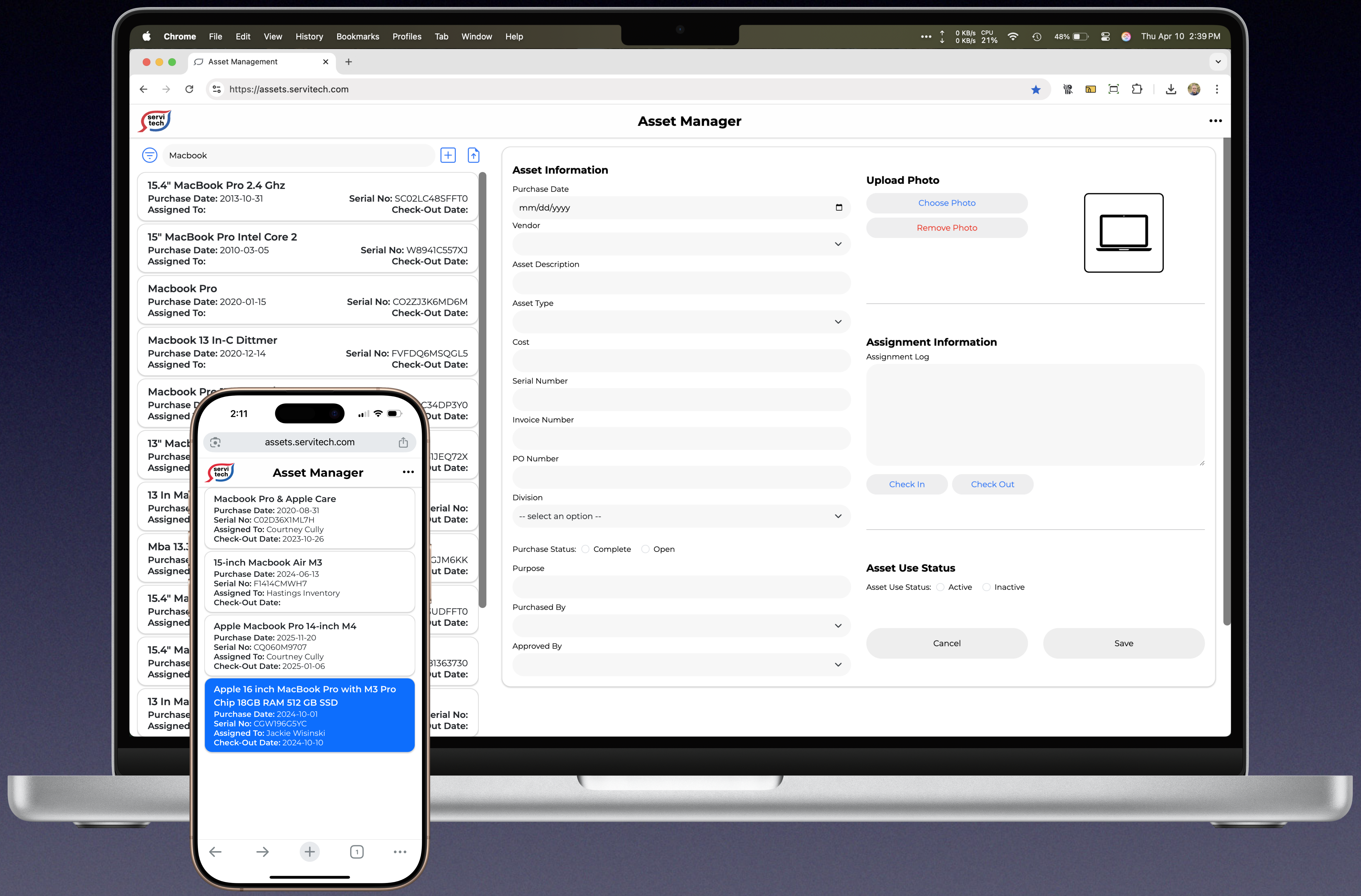
Results and Outcomes

The time elapsed between the ideation and final shipped web app was seven months—longer than I had anticipated when internal discussions began.

Long-tenured staff were unaware of the needs and desires of field-staff managers who managed dozens of devices provisioned to interns every spring and were returned in the late summer when interns returned to college.

Once the schema was defined and the app was launched, it took several days gather the raw data that comprised the asset list. The data had to be parsed and organized to fit the schema. Tags were assigned to assets by class and then filtered to remove data from unnecessary categories.

By November the asset data were uploaded and the service was launched to internal users.



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